

12 Brand Archetypes

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Personality framework for repositioning

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The 12 Brand Archetypes apply Jungian archetypes — such as the Hero, Sage, Creator and Outlaw — to brands, giving each a consistent personality that shapes voice, story and positioning.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Adapted to branding by Margaret Mark and Carol Pearson in *The Hero and the Outlaw* (2001), drawing on Carl Jung's archetypes.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed to give brands a coherent, resonant personality grounded in deep, universal patterns.

FIGURE 1 · 12 BRAND ARCHETYPES

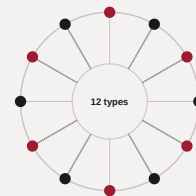


Figure 1. A schematic of the 12 Brand Archetypes as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

A brand is matched to an archetype that guides repositioning, tone and narrative consistently across touchpoints.

WHEN IT IS USED

During brand definition and rebranding.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Brand and marketing strategists.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It links brand personality to enduring psychological archetypes, giving rebrands a stable foundation for new expression.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

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Rebrand Decision Matrix · Slibrary 19

StoryBrand Framework · Slibrary 19

Brand Equity Bridge · Slibrary 19

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Mark, M. and Pearson, C.S. (2001) *The Hero and the Outlaw*. New York: McGraw-Hill.

Jung, C.G. (1968) *The Archetypes and the Collective Unconscious*. Princeton: PUP.